

John L. Radford

johnradford23@gmail.com • johnradford.io • github.com/BlueSquare23

1-412-780-2053 • Pittsburgh, PA

Summary

DevOps engineer and systems programmer with 6+ years at a production web hosting company. Builds internal tooling, automation, and infrastructure end-to-end, from distributed KVM clusters to custom RAG pipelines. Writes production Perl and Python, owns Linux systems, and ships full-stack internal tools.

Technical Skills

Languages: Perl, Python, Bash, PHP, JavaScript

Infra & Ops: Linux (RHEL/Ubuntu/FreeBSD), QEMU/KVM, Puppet, Ansible, Nginx, Apache, ELK Stack

Data & Caching: MySQL/MariaDB, Redis, ChromaDB

Security & Networking: SOC/SIEM, VPN, rate limiting, IP threat intelligence, HMAC auth

Tools: GitLab CI/CD, Netbox, CloudLinux, Icinga2, SureMDM, REST APIs, Plack/PSGI

Work Experience

DevOps Specialist & Systems Administrator - Pair Networks, Inc.

01/2023 – 05/2026

- Built a **Virtual Resource Manager** (Perl): per-host REST API agents broadcasting live CPU/mem/guest stats, a weighted-average rebalancing algorithm, and an interactive REPL CLI (`vrmtcl`) for manipulating the QEMU/KVM cluster.
- Developed a **custom RAG pipeline** (Python): ingested docs from GitLab, wikis, and knowledge bases; chunked, vectorized, and stored in ChromaDB; deployed tailored internal LLMs to assist support staff.
- Built a **centralized IP threat intelligence system**: Perl modules querying multiple public threat APIs, persisted to a central store with Redis caching to minimize redundant external calls.
- Developed a **Zendesk webhook API** (Perl Plack, HMAC-verified): auto-populated ticket fields from a username or account number, eliminating manual lookup for the entire support team.
- Integrated **Nginx/Apache rate limiting** into the Puppet build system; built a web stats pipeline for false-positive monitoring and threshold tuning.
- Developed a **KPI metrics pipeline**: automated collection of core business metrics from billing and account systems into a central database, replacing ad-hoc executive reporting.
- Integrated **CloudLinux** into the legacy build system and Puppet; built LVE fault reporting tooling, custom control panel integrations, and an Ansible playbook for fleet-wide deployment.
- Developed a **centralized web statistics pipeline**: Perl modules parsing raw access logs into structured JSON aggregated across the entire fleet via Ansible.

NOC & Security Technician - Pair Networks, Inc.

01/2020 – 12/2023

- Promoted to concurrent Security and NOC roles: monitored, detected, and remediated intrusions; triaged live production server incidents (hardware and software).
- Simultaneously handled Level 2 support, abuse team, and internal account migrations.
- Helped maintain the internal ELK centralized logging stack and SOC/SIEM monitoring infrastructure.

Support Technician - Pair Networks, Inc.

08/2018 – 12/2020

- Resolved customer issues across web hosting, email, DNS, domains, databases, and PHP configurations.
- Automated **SSL renewal notifications**, eliminating a highly manual process that previously consumed hours of support time per cycle.
- Built deep Linux hosting expertise across the full web stack that underpins all subsequent engineering roles.

Open Source Projects

Web-LGSM - web portal for managing Linux game servers

Term::ReadLine::Repl - published CPAN REPL module; used in production `vrmtcl` tooling

Acme::Shotgun - published CPAN module

Education

University of Pittsburgh - B.A., Humanities; Minor in Political Science (2017)